

THE WEST AFRICAN EXAMINATIONS COUNCIL

BASIC EDUCATION CERTIFICATE EXAMINATION -- JUNE 2008

ENGLISH LANGUAGE -- PAPER 1

Duration: 45 Minutes | Level: JHS 3 / BECE | Code: ENG 01/02 - P1

INSTRUCTIONS TO CANDIDATES

Answer all 40 questions. Choose from the alternatives lettered A to D the one that most suitably fills the gap or best explains the underlined word or phrase.

PART I: OBJECTIVE QUESTIONS

1. Neither the headmaster nor the teachers ____ present at the emergency assembly.
A. was
B. were
C. is
D. are being
2. The criminal was accused ____ stealing the village chief's gold chain.
A. for
B. with
C. of
D. about
3. She has been studying in this school ____ three years.
A. since
B. for
C. during
D. from
4. Choose the word nearest in meaning to the capitalized word: The doctor gave him a POTENT drug.
A. mild
B. powerful
C. bitter
D. dangerous
5. Choose the word opposite in meaning to the capitalized word: The market women welcomed the PROSPEROUS merchant.
A. wealthy
B. impoverished
C. generous
D. influential
6. Kofi is senior ____ Kwame by two years.
A. than
B. to
C. from
D. over
7. The match was called off because of the heavy rain. "Called off" means...
A. postponed
B. cancelled
C. delayed
D. replayed
8. You will pass your BECE examination, ____?
A. will you
B. won't you
C. can you
D. don't you

9. The jury arrived ____ a unanimous verdict.
- A. at
 - B. on
 - C. to
 - D. in
10. Choose the correct spelling:
- A. Accomodation
 - B. Accommodation
 - C. Acommodation
 - D. Accomadation
11. Despite the storm, the ship arrived safely. This means...
- A. The ship was destroyed by storm
 - B. The storm prevented the ship
 - C. Even though there was a storm, the ship reached safely
 - D. The ship waited for storm to stop
12. Each of the girls ____ given a prize.
- A. was
 - B. were
 - C. have been
 - D. are
13. The boy was bitten by a snake while he ____ through the tall grass.
- A. walked
 - B. was walking
 - C. is walking
 - D. has walked
14. Choose the word nearest in meaning: His explanations were OBSCURE.
- A. clear
 - B. unclear
 - C. accurate
 - D. loud
15. One of my cousins ____ in London.
- A. live
 - B. lives
 - C. are living
 - D. have lived
16. He is not only intelligent ____ hardworking.
- A. and
 - B. but also
 - C. also
 - D. as well as
17. The meeting was postponed SINE DIE. This means...
- A. indefinitely
 - B. for one week
 - C. to tomorrow
 - D. immediately
18. Kwesi prefers football ____ basketball.
- A. than
 - B. to
 - C. more than
 - D. over
19. Choose the correct plural form of "Commander-in-chief":
- A. Commander-in-chiefs
 - B. Commanders-in-chief
 - C. Commanders-in-chiefs
 - D. Commander-ins-chief

20. The police ____ investigating the armed robbery.

- A. is
- B. are
- C. was
- D. has been

OFFICIAL WAEC ANSWER KEY & SCORING GUIDE

For candidate self-assessment and teacher evaluation:

1. [B] 2. [C] 3. [B] 4. [B] 5. [B]
6. [B] 7. [B] 8. [B] 9. [A] 10. [B]
11. [C] 12. [A] 13. [B] 14. [B] 15. [B]
16. [B] 17. [A] 18. [B] 19. [B] 20. [B]